

[NT Lesson 22](#): “Inherit the Kingdom Prepared for You” Matthew 25 (See NTL22 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us prepare ourselves for the Second Coming through living righteously, developing and using our talents to build God’s Kingdom, and serving others.

†1. Matthew 25. Three Parables of Preparation

1. Jesus presents the parable of the ten virgins.

- Read [Matthew 25:1-13](#). “Then shall the kingdom of heaven be likened unto ten virgins”.

†2. “The Bridegroom Cometh”

†3. Elder Dallin H. Oaks

1. Look up and ask God what to prepare, see [Ether 12:27-28](#).
2. Kaizen—make a small Spirit-guided gospel-life improvement each day.

How do we sometimes make the same error as the foolish virgins?

- Matthew 25:12. “I know you not.” (See Matthew 25:12—JST)

†4. “Ye know **me** not.” (Emphasis mine.)

- [John 10:14](#). “I am the good shepherd, and know my sheep, **and am known of mine.**”
- [Mosiah 5:8-13](#). How “knoweth a man the master ... who ... is far from the thoughts and intents of his heart?”
- [2 Nephi 9:41-43](#). The “keeper of the gate is the Holy One of Israel”.

What can we learn from the actions of the five wise virgins? (See [D&C 45:56-57](#).)

What are some ways we can add “oil” to our “lamps”?

What did you do this past week to add oil to your lamp?

What would you do today if you knew Jesus were coming tomorrow?

What are some things you will do this week to add oil to your lamp?

2. Jesus presents the parable of the talents.

- Read [Matthew 25:14-30](#).

- [D&C 46:11-12](#). And “to every man is given a gift by the Spirit of God.”

What are some of your talents or gifts of the Spirit?

†5. Elder James E. Faust

How might you use your talents in the service of God and others today?

3. Jesus presents the parable of the sheep and the goats.

- Read [Matthew 25:31-46](#). And “he shall separate them ... as a shepherd divideth *his* sheep from the goats”.

What does this parable teach that we must do to prepare for Christ’s Second Coming?

†6. Elder Marion D. Hanks

How can we bless others by our service?

How has serving another person blessed you?

How do you feel about those you serve?

How can we become more aware of others’ needs?

How can we become more diligent in serving others?

How can we learn to delight in serving others?

Next Week: L23 “Love One Another, As I Have Loved You”; See L23: [Class Member Study Guide](#).
(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NTL20 Quotes

†1. Matthew 25. Three Parables of Preparation:

Parable	Main Message
Ten Virgins	Prepare spiritually for the Second Coming
Talents	We are accountable to the Lord for what we have done with spiritual gifts. He will reward us for developing those gifts.
Sheep and Goats	The Lord will judge each of us. Those who have faithfully served their fellowman will sit on “his right hand.”

(*New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 8: Matthew 24-25; Joseph Smith—Matthew](#),” 2014. Scroll down to: “[Matthew 25. Three Parables of Preparation](#)”.

†2. “**The Bridegroom cometh**”: “In biblical times the destination of those who ‘went forth to meet the bridegroom’ was the bridegroom’s home. Under the heading ‘Marriage’ in the Bible Dictionary, we read: ‘On the marriage day, the bride was escorted to her [bridegroom’s] home by a procession consisting of her own companions and the “friends of the bridegroom,” or “children of the bride-chamber.” ... When she reached the house, words such as “Take her according to the law of Moses ... “ were spoken, ... and a marriage deed was signed. After the prescribed washing of hands and benediction, the marriage supper was held’ (728–29).

“In the parable the bride and the virgins would have gone forth to meet the Bridegroom, or Lord, in His own house. In our day we might consider His own house to be the house of the Lord. As before mentioned, modern revelation teaches us that He will come to His own house: ‘The Lord ... shall suddenly come to his temple... Awake and arise and go forth to meet the Bridegroom; behold and lo, the Bridegroom cometh’ (D&C 133:2, 10; emphasis added).

“In the parable the Savior used a marriage ceremony in the Bridegroom’s home to teach about qualifying for the kingdom of heaven. In our day a marriage ceremony in the Lord’s house is the qualifying ordinance for family life in the celestial kingdom (see [D&C 131:1–3](#)).” (Elder Lynn G. Robbins, “[Oil in Our Lamps](#),” *Ensign*, June 2007.)

†3. Elder Dallin H. Oaks: “The ten virgins obviously represent members of Christ’s Church, for all were invited to the wedding feast and all knew what was

required to be admitted when the bridegroom came. But only half were ready when he came.

“... What if the day of His coming were tomorrow? If we knew that we would meet the Lord tomorrow—through our premature death or through His unexpected coming—what would we do today? What confessions would we make? What practices would we discontinue? What accounts would we settle? What forgivenesses would we extend? What testimonies would we bear?” (“[Preparation for the Second Coming](#),” *Ensign*, May 2004.)

†4. “**Ye know me not**”: “ ‘But he answered and said, Verily I say unto you, I know you not.’ (Matt. 25:1–12.)

“Joseph Smith made an insightful change in this parable in the inspired revision of the New Testament. Instead of saying, ‘I know you not,’ the Lord tells the five foolish virgins, ‘*Ye know me not.*’

“We sometimes wonder what it will be like to get to know the Savior in the next world. But that is missing the point. In our own day the Lord has said, ‘For strait is the gate, and narrow the way that leadeth unto the exaltation and continuation of the lives, and few there be that find it, because ye receive me not in the world neither do ye know me.’ (D&C 132:22. Italics added.) We must know Christ in *this* world.” (Karl T. Haglund, “[To Know Christ in This World](#),” *New Era*, April 1974.)

†5. Elder James E. Faust: “If their talents are used to build the kingdom of God and serve others, they will fully enjoy the promises of the Savior. The great promise of the Savior is that they ‘shall receive [their] reward, even peace in this world, and eternal life in the world to come’ (D&C 59:23)” (“[Five Loaves and Two Fishes](#),” *Ensign*, May 1994, 6).

†6. Elder Marion D. Hanks: “Jesus taught his followers the parable of the sheep and the goats ... The key difference was that those who should inherit the kingdom with him had developed the habit of helping, had experienced the joy of giving and the satisfaction of serving...

“... Helping, giving, and sacrificing are, or should be, as natural as growing and breathing” (“[The Royal Law](#),” *Ensign*, May 1992, 9).

Recommended Reading:

1. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 8: Matthew 24-25; Joseph Smith—Matthew](#),” 2014. Scroll down to: “Matthew 25. Three Parables of Preparation”.

2. NTL22 Enrichment.pdf contains more fine quotes and links to articles and speeches.

3. Elder Dallin H. Oaks, “[Preparation for the Second Coming](#),” *Ensign*, May 2004.

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